SSC MTS 2021 Paper-I question paper with answers

13 July 2022 · Shift 1

65 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: +1 for a right answer, –0.25 for a wrong one

The other 35 of the paper's 100 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://web.archive.org/web/20221017140324/https://ssc.nic.in/SSCFileServer/PortalManagement/UploadedFiles/Writeup_FinalAnswerKeyMTS2021_17102022.pdf

General English 24 questions

Q.1

The following sentence has been divided into parts. One of them may contain an error. Select the part that contains the error from the given options. If you don’t find any error, mark ‘No error’ as your answer. The mountain lion is / one of the slyest and more / elusive animals in the woods.

(A) one of the slyest and more
(B) No error
(C) The mountain lion is
(D) elusive animals in the woods.

Q.2

Select the correctly spelt word.

(A) Envisaige
(B) Psychologist
(C) Emergense
(D) Trancition

Q.3

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Overrun

(A) Surrender
(B) Inundate
(C) Storm
(D) Invade

Q.4

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. Many people may not find the rewards _____ with the time and effort required.

(A) insignificant
(B) gleeful
(C) cautious
(D) commensurate

Q.5

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. If we don't reverse course now, will anyone take anything we say about justice and _____ with any seriousness for decades to come?

(A) righteousness
(B) mediation
(C) wickedness
(D) dishonesty

Q.6

Select the most appropriate meaning of the underlined idiom in the given sentence. He is “foaming at the mouth” about the committee's decision.

(A) To be enraged and show it
(B) to cause damage to someone
(C) to not recognize something good
(D) to be upset about something that happened in the past

Q.8

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Probe

(A) Search
(B) Motivate
(C) Invite
(D) Push

Q.9

Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'. You are looking so "pretty on these" black outfit.

(A) pretty in this
(B) No improvement required
(C) prettier in these
(D) prettiest with those

Q.10

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. He is the patient _____ called you in the morning.

(A) which
(B) whom
(C) who
(D) that

Q.11

The following sentence has been divided into parts. One of them may contain an error. Select the part that contains the error from the given options. If you don't find any error, mark 'No error' as your answer. They finally did what / we advice them to do / before the final match.

(A) we advice them to do
(B) before the final match
(C) They finally did what
(D) No error

Q.12

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. Made in imitation so as to be passed off fraudulently as genuine

(A) Counterfeit
(B) Staunch
(C) Authentic
(D) Deliberate

Q.13

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. Many people like playing cricket, but _____ my opinion, it is too chaotic.

(A) in
(B) from
(C) for
(D) with

Q.14

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Impure

(A) Contaminated
(B) Segregated
(C) Sterile
(D) Concentrated

Q.15

The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error. If you plant a seed, / you will be noticed / that it takes some / time to grow.

(A) that it takes some
(B) If you plant a seed
(C) you will be noticed
(D) time to grow

Q.16

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. Back on one's feet

(A) To support the losing side
(B) Relive previous moments
(C) Well or successful again
(D) Forced to begin something again

Q.17

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. This cruise ship _____ in November and December.

(A) sails
(B) sells
(C) sales
(D) seals

Q.18

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. If you want to save your money, start living an _____ life.

(A) improper
(B) economical
(C) extravagant
(D) indulgent

Q.19

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Clandestine

(A) Blatant
(B) Ornate
(C) Open
(D) Undercover

Q.20

Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'. In India, processed foods “becomes popular in” the 20th century.

(A) became popular in
(B) become popularity in
(C) No improvement required
(D) become popular at

Q.21

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. The Ministry of Defence has (1) _____ the formal Government Sanction Letter (2) _____ grant of permanent commission (PC) to women officers in the Army. “In anticipation, the Army Headquarters had (3) _____ in motion a series of preparatory actions for conduct of the Permanent Commission Selection Board for affected women officers. The Selection Board will be scheduled as (4) _____ as all affected Short Service Commissioned (SSC) women officers exercise their option and complete (5) _____ documentation,” the Army said in a statement.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 1.

(A) imbibed
(B) accused
(C) extracted
(D) issued

Q.22

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. The Ministry of Defence has (1) _____ the formal Government Sanction Letter (2) _____ grant of permanent commission (PC) to women officers in the Army. “In anticipation, the Army Headquarters had (3) _____ in motion a series of preparatory actions for conduct of the Permanent Commission Selection Board for affected women officers. The Selection Board will be scheduled as (4) _____ as all affected Short Service Commissioned (SSC) women officers exercise their option and complete (5) _____ documentation,” the Army said in a statement.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 2.

(A) since
(B) from
(C) for
(D) to

Q.23

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. The Ministry of Defence has (1) _____ the formal Government Sanction Letter (2) _____ grant of permanent commission (PC) to women officers in the Army. “In anticipation, the Army Headquarters had (3) _____ in motion a series of preparatory actions for conduct of the Permanent Commission Selection Board for affected women officers. The Selection Board will be scheduled as (4) _____ as all affected Short Service Commissioned (SSC) women officers exercise their option and complete (5) _____ documentation,” the Army said in a statement.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 3.

(A) deposited
(B) set
(C) located
(D) situated

Q.24

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. The Ministry of Defence has (1) _____ the formal Government Sanction Letter (2) _____ grant of permanent commission (PC) to women officers in the Army. “In anticipation, the Army Headquarters had (3) _____ in motion a series of preparatory actions for conduct of the Permanent Commission Selection Board for affected women officers. The Selection Board will be scheduled as (4) _____ as all affected Short Service Commissioned (SSC) women officers exercise their option and complete (5) _____ documentation,” the Army said in a statement.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 4.

(A) soon
(B) late
(C) long
(D) blind

Q.25

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. The Ministry of Defence has (1) _____ the formal Government Sanction Letter (2) _____ grant of permanent commission (PC) to women officers in the Army. “In anticipation, the Army Headquarters had (3) _____ in motion a series of preparatory actions for conduct of the Permanent Commission Selection Board for affected women officers. The Selection Board will be scheduled as (4) _____ as all affected Short Service Commissioned (SSC) women officers exercise their option and complete (5) _____ documentation,” the Army said in a statement.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 5.

(A) unnecessary
(B) optional
(C) gratuitous
(D) requisite

General Intelligence and Reasoning 19 questions

Q.1

Identify the number that does NOT belong to the following series. 30, 15, 15, 22.5, 46, 112.5

(A) 46
(B) 112.5
(C) 22.5
(D) 30

Q.3

Select the option that is related to the fifth letter-cluster in the same way as the second letter-cluster is related to the first letter-cluster and the fourth letter-cluster is related to the third letter-cluster. VOCAL : CVJHS :: TROOF : AYVVM :: RTAGE : ?

(A) YAHNM
(B) YAHML
(C) YAHNN
(D) YAHNL

Q.6

If ‘White’ is called ‘Blue’, ‘Blue’ is called ‘Red’, ‘Red’ is called ‘Yellow’, Yellow' is called ‘Green’, ‘Green’ is called ‘Black’, ‘Black’ is called ‘Violet’, and ‘Violet’ is called ‘Orange’, then what would be the colour of human blood?

(A) Yellow
(B) Violet
(C) Red
(D) Green

Q.7

Select the number from among the given options that can replace the question mark (?) in the following series. 632, 637, 644, 653, 664, ?

(A) 677
(B) 687
(C) 679
(D) 681

Q.8

Read the given statements and conclusions carefully. Assuming that the information given in the statements is true, even if it appears to be at variance with commonly known facts, decide which of the given conclusions logically follow(s) from the statements. Statements: Some mocks are exams. Some exams are banks. No bank is a local. Conclusions: I. Some mocks are local. II. No mock is a local.

(A) Neither conclusion I nor II follows
(B) Only conclusion I follows
(C) Only conclusion II follows
(D) Either conclusion I or II follows

Q.9

Four boys R, S, T and U are sitting in a row, facing towards the south (but not necessarily in the same order). Four girls A, B, C and D are sitting in a row, facing towards the face of these boys (but not necessarily in the same order). C and R are diagonally opposite to each other. A and S are diagonally opposite to each other. T is the immediate neighbour of R. D is the immediate neighbour of C. Who is facing D?

(A) S
(B) T
(C) U
(D) R

Q.11

Which two numbers (not digits) need to be interchanged to make the given equation correct? 83 + 711 – 95 ÷ 9 × 2 = 20

(A) 9 and 2
(B) 711 and 95
(C) 95 and 83
(D) 2 and 83

Q.12

Select the option that is related to the fifth term in the same way as the second term is related to the first term and the fourth term is related to the third term. THROW : XPSIU :: QUICK : LDJVR :: LIGHT : ?

(A) UIHLM
(B) UIHJM
(C) UIHKM
(D) UIHJN

Q.13

Select the option that is related to the third number in the same way as the second number is related to the first number and sixth number is related to the fifth number. 6 : 232 :: 8 : ? : : 10 : 1016

(A) 520
(B) 535
(C) 540
(D) 528

Q.14

The speeds of seven cars C1, C2, C3, C4, C5, C6 and C7 are compared. All cars have different speeds. The speed of C1 is more than only two cars. The speed of C6 is more than C4 and less than C5. The speeds of C2 and C3 are the highest and the lowest, respectively. The speed of C4 is more than C1. The speed of how many cars is less than C7?

(A) 5
(B) 2
(C) 4
(D) 1

Q.15

Select the option that is related to the fifth number in the same way as the second number is related to the first number and the fourth number is related to the third number. 123 : 616 :: 147 : 736 :: 211 : ?

(A) 1056
(B) 1046
(C) 996
(D) 1036

Q.16

Select the letter-cluster that can replace the question mark (?) in the following series. GOAL, IMCJ, KKEH, MIGF, ?

(A) OHID
(B) OGJD
(C) OGIC
(D) OGID

Q.17

In a certain code language, '321' means 'cold filtered coffee', '653' means 'very cold day' and '985' means 'day and night'. What is the code for 'very' in the same language?

(A) 5
(B) 3
(C) 9
(D) 6

Q.18

In a certain code language, ‘grapes are multi red’ is coded as ‘8 6 4 3’, ‘red people eat mango’ is coded as ‘7 4 5 2’ and ‘mango multi apple’ is coded as ‘3 5 0’. How will ‘red apple’ be coded in that language?

(A) 8 5
(B) 4 0
(C) 5 0
(D) 8 6

Q.20

After interchanging the given two signs and two numbers, what will be the value of the following expression? ÷ and +; 7 and 15; 5 ÷ 35 + 15 × 6 – 7 = ?

(A) 40
(B) 30
(C) 20
(D) 10

Q.21

Select the option that is related to the third word in the same way as the second word is related to the first word. Canberra : Australia :: Doha : ?

(A) Qatar
(B) Iran
(C) Yemen
(D) Kuwait

Q.22

Read the given statements and conclusions carefully. Assuming that the information given in the statements is true, even if it appears to be at variance with commonly known facts, decide which of the given conclusions logically follow(s) from the statements. Statements: No 90s are 80s. Some 90s are 40s. All 80s are 70s. Conclusions: I. All 80s being 40s is a possibility. II. Some 70s are not 90s.

(A) Only conclusion II follows.
(B) Only conclusion I follows.
(C) Both conclusions I and II follow.
(D) Neither conclusion I nor II follow.

Q.23

In a certain code language, 'DETAIL' is written as 'FCVYKJ' and 'HEALTH' is written as 'JCCJVF'. How will 'MOTION' be written in that language?

(A) OMVGPL
(B) OMVGQM
(C) OMVGQL
(D) OMVGRL

Q.25

Seven girls A, B, C, D, E, F and G are sitting around a circular table facing opposite the centre (not necessarily in the same order). E is second to the right of A. C is the immediate neighbour of E. D is third to the right of C. B is the immediate neighbour of E and A. F is fourth to the right of A. Which of the following statements is correct? I. D is next to the right of G. II. A is third to the left of B.

(A) Only II
(B) Both I and II
(C) Only I
(D) Neither I nor II

General Awareness 22 questions

Q.1

'The Kiss of Life' is the autobiography of who among the following persons?

(A) Sanjay Suri
(B) John Abraham
(C) Dino Morea
(D) Emraan Hashmi

Q.2

In which state of India is Bhogali Bihu festival celebrated?

(A) Assam
(B) Andhra Pradesh
(C) Rajasthan
(D) Tamil Nadu

Q.3

Paika is a martial folk dance popular in which of the following states?

(A) Kerala
(B) Andhra Pradesh
(C) Gujarat
(D) Odisha

Q.4

Who is the author of the book 'Pride, Prejudice, and Punditry'?

(A) Manish Sisosdia
(B) Pranab Mukherjee
(C) Amitav Ghosh
(D) Shashi Tharoor

Q.5

Which of the following statements is INCORRECT?

(A) A post-anal tail is present in Chordates.
(B) Mollusca is the largest animal phylum.
(C) Ctenophores are commonly known as sea walnuts.
(D) Locust is an example of Arthropoda.

Q.6

Which of the following teams won the Ranji trophy for the year 2019-20?

(A) Mumbai
(B) Bengal
(C) Baroda
(D) Saurashtra

Q.8

In which of the following years was the Preamble of the Indian Constitution first amended?

(A) 1968
(B) 1955
(C) 1976
(D) 1988

Q.10
Which of the following rivers is also known as 'Bhagirathi' at the place of its origin?

(A) Brahmaputra
(B) Yamuna
(C) Indus
(D) Ganga

Q.11
Which of the following railway zones has recently completed 100% electrification of its entire route?

(A) South Central Railway
(B) Konkan Railway
(C) Harbour Railway
(D) North Eastern Railway

Q.12
Who of the following founded the Atmiya Samaj?

(A) Swami Vivekananda
(B) Bhimrao Ramji Ambedkar
(C) Raja Ram Mohan Roy
(D) Dayananda Saraswati

Q.13
Aparna Satheesan, who won the prestigious National Nritya Shiromani Award 2022, is associated with which of the following dance forms?

(A) Sattriya
(B) Kuchipudi
(C) Mohiniattam
(D) Kathak

Q.14
_____ is a motion moved by a member to cut short the debate on a matter before the House.

(A) Closure
(B) No-Confidence
(C) Privilege
(D) Censure

Q.15
The Battle of Khanwa was fought between:

(A) Babur and Ibrahim Lodi
(B) Babur and Rana Sangha
(C) Sher Shah Suri and Rana Sangha
(D) Babur and Sher Shah Suri

Q.16
Which of the following is the oldest Veda?

(A) Rigveda
(B) Atharvaveda
(C) Samaveda
(D) Yajurveda

Q.18
Who became the first Governor–General of India in 1773?

(A) Robert Clive
(B) Warren Hastings
(C) Thomas Munro
(D) Charles Cornwallis

Q.19
Which of the following is NOT an institutional factor for agriculture?

(A) Land reforms
(B) Electricity
(C) Size of fields
(D) Land tenure

Q.20
As per the 2011 census, which of the following states of India has the least population?

(A) Sikkim
(B) Bihar
(C) Kerala
(D) Chhattisgarh

Q.21

Pandit Ram Narayan was associated with which musical instrument?

(A) Flute
(B) Sarod
(C) Sarangi
(D) Guitar

Q.22

Which of the following is an example of emulsion?

(A) Milk
(B) Mist
(C) Gemstone
(D) Clouds

Q.23

India won the bronze medal (the only one won by India) in which team sports at the Tokyo Olympics 2020?

(A) Basketball
(B) Field hockey
(C) Badminton
(D) Table tennis

Q.24

_____ won the women's singles title at the Swiss Open Super 300 badminton tournament 2022.

(A) PV Sindhu
(B) Kirsty Gilmour
(C) Ashmita Chaliha
(D) Busanan Ongbamrungphan

Q.25

According to the census 2011, the second highest populated metro in India is:

(A) Bengaluru
(B) Chennai
(C) Delhi
(D) Mumbai

Answer key

General English

Q.1 **(A)**	Q.2 **(B)**	Q.3 **(A)**	Q.4 **(D)**	Q.5 **(A)**	Q.6 **(A)**
Q.8 **(A)**	Q.9 **(A)**	Q.10 **(C)**	Q.11 **(A)**	Q.12 **(A)**	Q.13 **(A)**
Q.14 **(C)**	Q.15 **(C)**	Q.16 **(C)**	Q.17 **(A)**	Q.18 **(B)**	Q.19 **(D)**
Q.20 **(A)**	Q.21 **(D)**	Q.22 **(C)**	Q.23 **(B)**	Q.24 **(A)**	Q.25 **(D)**

General Intelligence and Reasoning

Q.1 **(A)**	Q.3 **(D)**	Q.6 **(A)**	Q.7 **(A)**	Q.8 **(D)**	Q.9 **(C)**
Q.11 **(B)**	Q.12 **(B)**	Q.13 **(D)**	Q.14 **(D)**	Q.15 **(A)**	Q.16 **(D)**
Q.17 **(D)**	Q.18 **(B)**	Q.20 **(C)**	Q.21 **(A)**	Q.22 **(C)**	Q.23 **(C)**
Q.25 **(C)**					

General Awareness

Q.1 **(D)**	Q.2 **(A)**	Q.3 **(D)**	Q.4 **(D)**	Q.5 **(B)**	Q.6 **(D)**
Q.8 **(C)**	Q.10 **(D)**	Q.11 **(B)**	Q.12 **(C)**	Q.13 **(B)**	Q.14 **(A)**
Q.15 **(B)**	Q.16 **(A)**	Q.18 **(B)**	Q.19 **(B)**	Q.20 **(A)**	Q.21 **(C)**
Q.22 **(A)**	Q.23 **(B)**	Q.24 **(A)**	Q.25 **(C)**		

Explanations

General English

Q.1 · Answer (A) one of the slyest and more

After 'one of the', both adjectives need the superlative: 'one of the slyest and most elusive animals', not 'more elusive'.

Q.2 · Answer (B) Psychologist

'Psychologist' is spelt correctly; the others should be 'envisage', 'emergence' and 'transition'.

Q.3 · Answer (A) Surrender

To overrun a place is to invade and occupy it, close to 'inundate', 'storm' and 'invade'; to 'surrender' is to give it up.

Q.4 · Answer (D) commensurate

'Commensurate with' means in proportion to: the rewards may not match the time and effort required.

Q.5 · Answer (A) righteousness

'Righteousness', being morally right, pairs with 'justice'; 'wickedness' and 'dishonesty' are its opposites, and 'mediation' does not fit the pair.

Q.6 · Answer (A) To be enraged and show it

To be 'foaming at the mouth' is to be extremely angry and to show it.

Q.8 · Answer (A) Search

To 'probe' is to search into or investigate something closely.

Q.9 · Answer (A) pretty in this

'Outfit' is singular, so it takes 'this', not 'these', and one looks pretty 'in' clothes, not 'on' them: 'You are looking so pretty in this black outfit.'

Q.10 · Answer (C) who

SSC's key gives 'who', the relative pronoun for a person as the subject of the clause: 'the patient who called you'. 'That' is also used for people in such defining clauses, but 'who' is the preferred form; 'which' is for things and 'whom' is an object form.

Q.11 · Answer (A) we advice them to do

'Advice' is a noun; the verb is 'advise', here in the past tense to match 'did': 'what we advised them to do'.

Q.12 · Answer (A) Counterfeit

Something 'counterfeit' is a fake made to pass as genuine, such as a forged banknote. 'Authentic' means the opposite.

Q.13 · Answer (A) in

The fixed phrase is 'in my opinion'.

Q.14 · Answer (C) Sterile

'Sterile' means free from germs or contamination, the opposite of 'impure'; 'contaminated' means much the same as 'impure'.

Q.15 · Answer (C) you will be noticed

'You' are the one who notices, so the verb must be active: 'you will notice that it takes some time to grow'.

Q.16 · Answer (C) Well or successful again

To be 'back on one's feet' is to be healthy or successful again after illness or trouble.

Q.17 · Answer (A) sails

A ship 'sails', that is travels by sea; 'sells', 'sales' and 'seals' sound or look alike but do not fit.

Q.18 · Answer (B) economical
An 'economical' life avoids waste and spends with care, which saves money; 'extravagant' and 'indulgent' mean the opposite.

Q.19 · Answer (D) Undercover
'Clandestine' means kept or done in secret: 'undercover'. 'Blatant' and 'open' are its opposites, and 'ornate' means richly decorated.

Q.20 · Answer (A) became popular in
'In the 20th century' is past time, so the verb takes the past tense, which also suits the plural 'foods': 'processed foods became popular in the 20th century'.

Q.21 · Answer (D) issued
A ministry 'issues' a sanction letter, that is sends it out officially.

Q.22 · Answer (C) for
The letter is 'for' the grant of permanent commission: 'for' gives its purpose.

Q.23 · Answer (B) set
To 'set in motion' is to start a process: the Army had started a series of preparatory actions.

Q.24 · Answer (A) soon
'As soon as' means at the moment when: the board will be scheduled once the officers have exercised their option.

Q.25 · Answer (D) requisite
'Requisite' means required: the officers must complete the necessary documentation. 'Unnecessary', 'optional' and 'gratuitous' go against the sense.

General Intelligence and Reasoning

Q.1 · Answer (A) 46
Each term is the one before times 0.5, 1, 1.5, 2 and 2.5 in turn: 30 × 0.5 = 15, 15 × 1 = 15, 15 × 1.5 = 22.5, 22.5 × 2 = 45 and 45 × 2.5 = 112.5. So 46 should be 45.

Q.3 · Answer (D) YAHNL
Each letter moves 7 places forward, wrapping round after Z: VOCAL → CVJHS and TROOF → AYVVM. So RTAGE → YAHNL.

Q.6 · Answer (A) Yellow
Human blood is red, and 'Red' is called 'Yellow'.

Q.7 · Answer (A) 677
The differences are 5, 7, 9 and 11, so the next is 13: 664 + 13 = 677.

Q.8 · Answer (D) Either conclusion I or II follows
Nothing links mocks with locals, so neither conclusion follows by itself. But 'some mocks are local' and 'no mock is a local' cannot both be false, so one of the two must hold.

Q.9 · Answer (C) U
C and R sit at opposite ends of the two rows, as do A and S; since C and A are both girls, C faces S and A faces R. T sits next to R, leaving U second from S's end, and D sits next to C, in the seat facing U.

Q.11 · Answer (B) 711 and 95
Interchanging 711 and 95: 83 + 95 – 711 ÷ 9 × 2 = 83 + 95 – 79 × 2 = 178 – 158 = 20.

Q.12 · Answer (B) UIHJM
The word is written backwards and each letter moves 1 place forward: THROW → WORHT → XPSIU and QUICK → KCIUQ → LDJVR. So LIGHT → THGIL → UIHJM.

Q.13 · Answer (D) 528
Each second number is the cube of the first plus 16: $6^3 + 16 = 232$ and $10^3 + 16 = 1016$. So $8^3 + 16 = 512 + 16 = 528$.

Q.14 · Answer (D) 1
C3 is the slowest, and C1, faster than only two cars, is third slowest. C4 is faster than C1, C6 faster than C4 and C5 faster than C6, with C2 the fastest, so C7 is second slowest: only C3 is slower.

Q.15 · Answer (A) 1056
Each second number is the first times 5, plus 1: $123 \times 5 + 1 = 616$ and $147 \times 5 + 1 = 736$. So $211 \times 5 + 1 = 1056$.

Q.16 · Answer (D) OGID
The first letters move +2 (G, I, K, M, O), the second –2 (O, M, K, I, G), the third +2 (A, C, E, G, I) and the fourth –2 (L, J, H, F, D): OGID.

Q.17 · Answer (D) 6
'Cold' is in the first two phrases and 3 in both their codes; 'day' is in the last two and 5 in both their codes. So in 'very cold day' = 653, 'very' is 6.

Q.18 · Answer (B) 4 0
'Red' is in the first two phrases, whose codes share only 4; 'mango' is in the last two (shared 5) and 'multi' in the first and third (shared 3). So in 'mango multi apple' = 3 5 0, 'apple' is 0, and 'red apple' is 4 0.

Q.20 · Answer (C) 20
Interchanging ÷ and + and 7 and 15: $5 + 35 \div 7 \times 6 - 15 = 5 + 30 - 15 = 20$.

Q.21 · Answer (A) Qatar
Canberra is the capital of Australia, and Doha is the capital of Qatar.

Q.22 · Answer (C) Both conclusions I and II follow.
The 40s that are 90s cannot be 80s, but the other 40s may take in every 80, so I is a possibility. Every 80 is a 70 and no 80 is a 90, so the 70s that are 80s are not 90s: II follows.

Q.23 · Answer (C) OMVGQL
The letters move +2 and –2 in turn: DETAIL → FCVYKJ and HEALTH → JCCJVF. So MOTION → OMVGQL.

Q.25 · Answer (C) Only I
Facing away from the centre, each girl's right is clockwise. Clockwise from A the order is A, B, E, C, F, G, D: E is second to A's right with B between them, C is next to E, F fourth to A's right and D third to C's right. D sits just to G's right, so I holds; A is B's immediate left-hand neighbour, not third to her left, so II is false.

General Awareness

Q.1 · Answer (D) Emraan Hashmi
'The Kiss of Life: How a Superhero and My Son Defeated Cancer' (2016), written by Emraan Hashmi with Bilal Siddiqi, tells of his young son's fight against cancer.

Q.2 · Answer (A) Assam
Bhogali or Magh Bihu, Assam's harvest festival of feasting and bonfires, is held in mid-January at the end of the harvest season.

Q.3 · Answer (D) Odisha
Paika, danced with swords or spears and shields, recalls the Paikas, the peasant militia of Odisha's old kingdoms.

Q.4 · Answer (D) Shashi Tharoor
'Pride, Prejudice and Punditry: The Essential Shashi Tharoor' (2021) is a collection of Shashi Tharoor's writings.

Q.5 · Answer (B) Mollusca is the largest animal phylum.
Arthropoda, not Mollusca, is the largest animal phylum; molluscs form the second largest. The other three statements are true.

Q.6 · Answer (D) Saurashtra
Saurashtra won their first Ranji Trophy in 2019-20, taking the first-innings lead over Bengal in the drawn final at Rajkot in March 2020.

Q.8 · Answer (C) 1976
The 42nd Amendment Act of 1976 amended the Preamble, adding the words 'socialist', 'secular' and 'integrity'.

Q.10 · Answer (D) Ganga
The Ganga rises as the Bhagirathi from the Gangotri glacier at Gaumukh, and takes the name Ganga at Devprayag, where the Alaknanda joins it.

Q.11 · Answer (B) Konkan Railway
Konkan Railway completed the electrification of its whole 741 km route, from Roha in Maharashtra to Thokur in Karnataka, in March 2022. (It is run by the Konkan Railway Corporation rather than as one of the zonal railways.)

Q.12 · Answer (C) Raja Ram Mohan Roy
Raja Ram Mohan Roy founded the Atmiya Sabha (Society of Friends) in Calcutta in 1815, a forerunner of his Brahmo Sabha of 1828.

Q.13 · Answer (B) Kuchipudi
SSC's key gives Kuchipudi: Aparna Satheesan, a dancer from Thiruvananthapuram based in the United States, was chosen for the National Nritya Shiromani Award 2022 at the Cuttack Mahotsav in Odisha for promoting Kuchipudi around the world. She also dances Bharatanatyam and trained in Mohiniyattam, but the award was for Kuchipudi.

Q.14 · Answer (A) Closure
A closure motion, once adopted, ends the debate on a matter so that it can be put to the vote. No-confidence and censure motions are directed at the government, and a privilege motion concerns a breach of parliamentary privilege.

Q.15 · Answer (B) Babur and Rana Sangha
At Khanwa, near Fatehpur Sikri, Babur defeated Rana Sanga of Mewar in March 1527; he had defeated Ibrahim Lodi at Panipat the year before.

Q.16 · Answer (A) Rigveda
The Rigveda, a collection of hymns in ten books (mandalas), is the oldest of the four Vedas; the Samaveda and the Yajurveda draw on its verses.

Q.18 · Answer (B) Warren Hastings
SSC's key gives Warren Hastings: the Regulating Act of 1773 made the Governor of Bengal the Governor-General of Bengal, and Hastings was the first to hold the post. Strictly, the title Governor-General of India came only with the Charter Act of 1833, under Lord William Bentinck, who is not an option.

Q.19 · Answer (B) Electricity
Institutional factors concern how land is owned and organised: land tenure, land reforms and the size of fields (holdings). Electricity is a technological or infrastructural input.

Q.20 · Answer (A) Sikkim
Sikkim, with about 6.1 lakh people in the 2011 census, is India's least populous state; Bihar, Kerala and Chhattisgarh each had more than 2.5 crore.

Q.21 · Answer (C) Sarangi
Pandit Ram Narayan made the sarangi, long an accompanying instrument, a solo concert instrument.

Q.22 · Answer (A) Milk
An emulsion is one liquid dispersed in another: milk is droplets of fat in water. Mist and clouds are a liquid in a gas (aerosols), and a gemstone is a solid in a solid (a solid sol).

Q.23 · Answer (B) Field hockey
India's men's hockey team beat Germany 5-4 for the bronze at Tokyo, India's first Olympic hockey medal since 1980.

Q.24 · Answer (A) PV Sindhu
P V Sindhu beat Thailand's Busanan Ongbamrungphan in the final of the Swiss Open in Basel in March 2022.

Q.25 · Answer (C) Delhi
In the 2011 census, the Greater Mumbai urban agglomeration (about 1.84 crore) was the most populous, followed by Delhi's (about 1.63 crore) and then Kolkata's.

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